

TRUEFLOW · FREE FIELD GUIDE

The Q2/2026 Business Owner's AI Toolkit

A no-fluff field guide to deciding what AI is actually worth your time — the same framework we run on day one inside a client's business.

Inside: the AI Strike Zone · the 2-Question Rule · a Green/Yellow/Red checklist · the Slice It method · 10 copy-paste prompts · a fill-in workflow audit.

Start here: the AI Strike Zone

Most AI advice tells you everything is about to change. Useful if you have unlimited time. You don't. So the only question that matters is narrow: **which specific tasks are in AI's strike zone today** — reliable enough to hand over without babysitting?

Two findings draw the lines of that zone:

The 4-minute line	AI completes short, well-scoped tasks at near-100% reliability when they take a person under ~4 minutes — and reliability falls below 10% on tasks that would take a person more than a few hours. (METR, 2025)
The 80% trap	More than 80% of AI projects fail — about double the failure rate of regular IT projects. The failures aren't the model; they're scope. (RAND, 2024)

The takeaway: don't ask "can AI do my job?" Ask "which 4-minute pieces of my job am I doing 50 times a week?" That's the strike zone. Everything in this toolkit helps you find those pieces and hand them over safely.

The 2-Question Strike-Zone Rule

Before you automate anything, run it through two questions. Both have to be "yes."

1. Is it short and repeatable?

Could a capable person finish one instance in a few minutes, and do you do it over and over? Short + frequent = the sweet spot.

2. Can you check the answer fast?

If the AI is wrong, would you notice in seconds — or only after it's caused damage? Hand over tasks where mistakes are *cheap and visible*, not silent and expensive.

Two yeses → automate it this week. One yes → keep a human in the loop. Two nos → leave it alone for now.

The Green / Yellow / Red checklist

A fast gut-check for any task you're tempted to hand to AI.

GREEN — hand it over now

- Drafting first-pass replies, summaries, and follow-ups you'll skim before sending
- Cleaning, formatting, and tagging data you can eyeball
- Turning notes into checklists, outlines, or SOPs
- Repetitive research with a clear, checkable answer

YELLOW — keep a human in the loop

- Anything that goes to a customer unedited
- Numbers that feed a decision (pricing, forecasts, payroll)
- Judgment calls where “mostly right” isn't good enough

RED — not the strike zone yet

- Final approvals, contracts, and anything legally binding
- Tasks where a wrong answer is silent and expensive
- Work you can't verify because you don't know the right answer yourself

The “Slice It” method

Most AI projects fail because people hand over a whole *job* instead of a *task*. “Run my marketing” fails. “Draft three subject lines from this paragraph” works. Slice the job until each piece passes the 2-Question Rule:

- 1 Write the job as one sentence (“handle customer support”).
- 2 List every step a person actually takes to do it.
- 3 Circle the steps that are short, repeatable, and checkable.
- 4 Hand *only those* to AI. Keep the rest — for now.

10 copy-paste prompts

Paste into any capable assistant. Replace the [brackets]. These are scoped to land in the strike zone.

1. Inbox triage

Here are 10 emails: [paste]. For each, give me a one-line summary and label it Reply Now, Reply Later, or Ignore.

2. First-draft reply

Draft a warm, concise reply to this message: [paste]. Keep it under 120 words. I'll edit before sending.

3. Meeting to action items

Turn these notes into a list of action items with owners and due dates: [paste].

4. SOP from memory

I'll describe how I do [task]. Turn it into a clean step-by-step SOP a new hire could follow: [describe].

5. Spreadsheet cleanup

Here's messy data: [paste]. Standardize the formatting, flag anything that looks wrong, and return a clean table.

6. Subject line tester

Give me 5 subject-line options for this email, ranked, with one reason each: [paste].

7. Objection prep

A prospect in [industry] is hesitant about [concern]. Give me 3 honest, non-pushy responses.

8. Content repurpose

Turn this [blog post/transcript] into 3 short social posts in a plain, no-hype voice: [paste].

9. Decision checklist

I'm deciding whether to [decision]. List the 5 questions I should answer first, and what a good answer looks like.

10. Weekly review

Here's what happened this week: [paste]. Summarize wins, open loops, and the 3 things I should focus on Monday.

Your 20-minute workflow audit

Fill this in once. It's the fastest way to find your first three AI wins. List the tasks you repeat most, then score each with the 2-Question Rule.

Task you repeat	Times / week	Short & repeatable	Easy to check?	Verdict

How to score: a task with two “yes” answers and a high times/week count is your first automation. Start there. Ship one this week before touching the next.

That’s the whole method: find the short, repeatable, checkable pieces — hand those over — keep the judgment. Do that on three tasks and you’ll feel it by Friday.

— Matt & the TrueFlow team

Sources: METR, “Measuring AI Ability to Complete Long Tasks” (2025); RAND, “Why AI Projects Fail and How They Can Succeed” (2024). TrueFlow · trueflow.ai